

Week 4 - Rebalancing instead of panicking

Prepared for Dad - 30 March 2026

Snapshot

Portfolio value	Around £1,860
Starting value	Around £1,999
Realised loss on trims	About \$10
Main action	Trimmed IonQ and Symbotic; added SGLN, Meta and Realty Income

Where the account stood

The account was still sitting around £1,860, compared with roughly £1,999 at the start. So on paper the portfolio was still under pressure. I did not like seeing that, but I still viewed it as a difficult market backdrop rather than proof that the whole structure was wrong.

The broad picture was similar to Week 3. The core still made sense, but the volatile sleeve had become the part causing most of the discomfort. That made the next decision fairly clear: I needed to reduce the part of the portfolio that was creating the most unnecessary pressure.

The rebalance

The main thing I did was trim some of the speculative exposure. I cut 1.5 shares of IonQ and 0.8 shares of Symbotic, then reallocated into steadier positions: SGLN, Meta and Realty Income. I did not see that as trading for the sake of trading. It was more about improving the balance of the account after seeing how the portfolio behaved under pressure.

The trims realised a loss of about \$10. That is not something I would want to make a habit of, but in this case I think it was acceptable because the loss was small and the decision

made the account healthier. I would rather take a small controlled loss than sit passively in positions that had become too large a source of volatility.

Market backdrop and my view

The wider market was still focused on the Middle East and oil. Trump had said attacks would pause for ten days while talks continued, which helped reduce some immediate fear, but it did not remove the uncertainty. Oil was still elevated because investors were worried about escalation and supply disruption.

My view at the time was that Iran would probably respect the pause for the time being, or at least avoid doing something that forced immediate escalation before the deadline. That was only my interpretation, not a fact, but it matched the way markets were behaving: calmer than before, but not relaxed.

For the portfolio, I expected continued volatility rather than a clean recovery. If diplomacy held, Meta, Alphabet and ASML could recover gradually. If the pause broke, oil and inflation fears could keep putting pressure on growth, REITs and rate-sensitive holdings.

Where the portfolio ended up

After the rebalance, the account looked more controlled. It still had exposure to growth and AI through Meta, Alphabet and ASML. It still had broad exposure through the ETFs. But it was less dependent on the speculative sleeve behaving well every week.

Ticker	Holding	Shares after rebalance
ABNB	Airbnb	1.2230
ASML	ASML Holding	0.1190
BRK.B	Berkshire Hathaway	0.3884
GOOGL	Alphabet	0.8032
IONQ	IonQ	2.1190
META	Meta Platforms	0.4200
NEE	NextEra Energy	2.0400

O	Realty Income	3.2780
QQQA	UBS Nasdaq-100 (Acc)	6.5662
RHM	Rheinmetall	0.0868
SGLN	iShares Physical Gold	4.7193
SYM	Symbotic	1.7680
VUAG	Vanguard S&P 500 (Acc)	2.0366